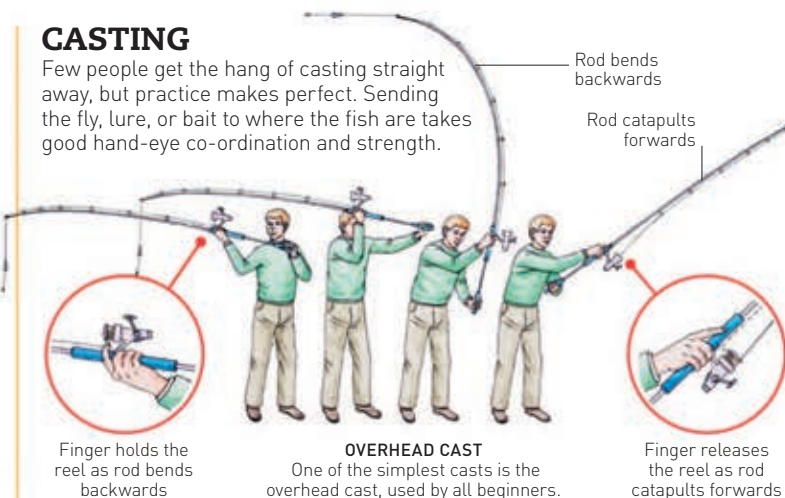


CASTING

Few people get the hang of casting straight away, but practice makes perfect. Sending the fly, lure, or bait to where the fish are takes good hand-eye co-ordination and strength.



OVERHEAD CAST
One of the simplest casts is the overhead cast, used by all beginners.

BIGGEST CATCH

Big-game fishing happens out in the open ocean. Tuna, marlin, and swordfish are popular targets, and the aim is to catch the biggest fish possible. The record for the heaviest Atlantic bluefin tuna was set in 1932 by English fisherman Edward Peel, using a rod and line.



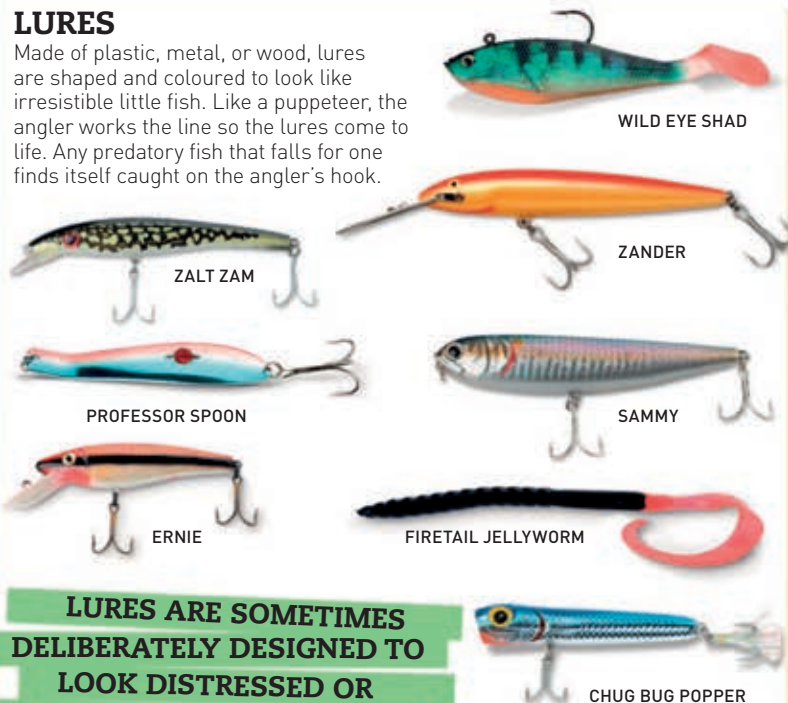
WEIGHING

All anglers want to know how much their catch weighs – so they can compete with each other, and with their own personal bests. For catch-and-release fishing, it is especially important to use scales that do not cause any extra distress.



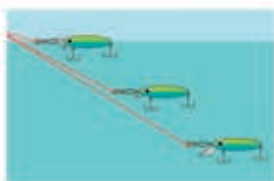
LURES

Made of plastic, metal, or wood, lures are shaped and coloured to look like irresistible little fish. Like a puppeteer, the angler works the line so the lures come to life. Any predatory fish that falls for one finds itself caught on the angler's hook.



LURES ARE SOMETIMES DELIBERATELY DESIGNED TO LOOK DISTRESSED OR INJURED – LIKE EASY PREY

DEPTHS
Lures can be weighted to "swim" at different depths, so that they appeal to specific predators.



PIKE LURE
Pike will go for a lure at any depth. The lure has to be on a wire line as a pike has a fierce bite.

FLOATS

Like weights, floats help suspend bait or a lure at a particular depth in the water. Some come ready-weighted, but others are used with lead weights or shot. Lighter floats are ideal for still water. Fast-moving water needs heavier floats.



COLOURFUL FLOATS
Bright colours attract fish and also help the angler keep track of where the float is in the water.

UNUSUAL FISHING METHODS

People have caught fish throughout history, gathering food from rivers and the sea just as they hunted animals on land. Over the centuries, people came up with many weird and wonderful ways to catch fish.

ON STILTS

Stilt fishermen in Sri Lanka drive their poles into the sand just offshore, then perch at the top and cast their lines. This technique means they disturb the fish as little as possible.



STILTS

USING SUCKER FISH

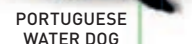
Remoras are suckerfish that hitch a ride on larger fish. In Africa, some fishermen use them on their fishing lines. When they feel the remora has attached its sucker to a big fish, they haul it in.



PORTUGUESE WATER DOG

WITH DOGS

Fishermen along the coast of Portugal traditionally used water dogs to herd fish into their nets.



USING CORMORANTS

Chinese and Japanese fishermen use trained cormorants. A throat snare stops the birds swallowing bigger fish, but is loose enough to let them eat smaller ones.



CORMORANTS

WITH DOLPHINS

A pod of dolphins in Laguna, Brazil, helps the local fishermen by driving shoals of mullet towards the shore. The dolphins even leap out of the water to tell the people the right moment to cast their nets.

FLY-FISHING

Fly-fishing began as a way of catching river salmon and trout. Today, it is popular for a huge range of fresh- and saltwater species. The angler uses fake flies to tempt the fish. Some are cast on to the surface of the water (dry flies), and some into the water (wet flies). Flies can be lifelike (deceivers) or come in crazy colours (attractors).



WRIST ACTION
In streams or rivers, the fly-angler aims to cast the fly upstream. Then it will gently drift downstream in a natural-looking way.

ATTRACTORS

Attractors are often brightly coloured. The fly-angler usually moves them around a lot to tempt fish to attack.

